

Class 10th | English



First Flight

THE TREES

LECTURE - 2

QUESTIONS

1. Who has been personified in the line 'no sun bury its feet in shadow'?
- (a) Sun
 - (b) Shadow
 - (c) Feet
 - (d) None of these



QUESTIONS

Ans. (a) Sun

QUESTIONS

2. What reaches like a voice into the rooms?
- (a) Noise of the roots
 - (b) Shuffling of the branches
 - (c) Smell of leaves and lichens
 - (d) Light of the moon

QUESTIONS

Ans. (c) Smell of leaves and lichens

QUESTIONS

3. Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.

All night the roots work
to disengage themselves from the cracks
in the veranda floor.

The leaves strain toward the glass small
twigs stiff with exertion
long-cramped boughs shuffling under the roof
like newly discharged patients
half-dazed, moving
to the clinic doors.

QUESTIONS

i. What does the poet compare the larger branches to?

Ans. The poet compares the larger branches with patients who have been recently discharged and are leaving the clinic doors.

QUESTIONS

ii. What struggle do the trees go through to free themselves from the boundaries?

Ans. Every part of the trees works to get itself free. The roots struggle to break free from the cracks of the veranda floor while the leaves put pressure on the window glass to break it. The large branches try to break open the roof to get out of the house.

QUESTIONS

- iii. The poet thinks that the trees _____ night.
- (a) work to free themselves from the boundaries of the house at
 - (b) grow underground slowly to take over the house during the
 - (c) spread their roots to beyond the boundaries to surround the house during the
 - (d) All of the above

QUESTIONS

Ans. (a) work to free themselves from the boundaries of the house at

QUESTIONS

iv. What do roots work upon all night?

Ans. Roots work to free themselves from the cracks in the veranda floor.

QUESTIONS

4. Why are the trees moving outside?

Ans. The trees are moving outside because they want to set themselves free from the walls that humans have put around them. They belong to the forest and that's why they are making efforts to go there.

QUESTIONS

5. Why are the trees described in the first Stanza not useful for birds or insects?

Ans. The trees described in the first Stanza are not useful for birds or insects because they are decorative plants. Such ornamental plants/trees are kept in the house in the form of sculptures, paintings or picture. Therefore, they do not serve nature. Birds cannot sit on their branches and insects cannot hide in them.

QUESTIONS

6. Describe the struggle of the roots, leaves, small twigs and long boughs to free themselves and break open the artificial barriers created by man.

Ans. In the poem, the trees and its roots, leaves, small twigs and long boughs put in a lot of efforts to break the artificial barriers created by man. The roots of the tree struggle all night to break free from the cracks of the veranda floor.

QUESTIONS

7. How is the night when the forests depart from the house? What are the changes that the poet expects to take place during the night/by the morning?

Ans. When the forests depart from the house, the night outside is fresh. The sky is clear with the whole Moon shining brightly. The poet expects that during the night the trees will move out of the house. So, by the morning, the trees will cover the forests that were treeless.

QUESTIONS

8. The process of 'moving out' was tedious for the trees. Support the statement with reference to the poem.

Ans. It is true that the process of 'moving out' was tedious for the trees. The poet says that the roots worked for the whole night to separate themselves from the veranda floor. The leaves tried hard to reach the window of glass so that they could go outside. Even the small stems of the trees put much of their effort in order to set themselves free.

QUESTIONS

9. The poem ends on a note of victory. Justify with reference to the literal and symbolic meaning.

Ans. The poem 'The Trees' ends with the note of victory for both trees and women. Trees have escaped and entered their natural habitat after a lot of struggle. Similarly, the poet is sure that the women will also taste freedom after this struggle.

QUESTIONS

10. The trees in the poem stretch out their branches, break barriers and struggle hard to move out in the open in their natural environment. Analyse the efforts that one puts in to break away captivity and strive for freedom.

Ans. A lot of efforts are put in to break away from captivity and to enjoy freedom. For anyone, freedom is much more important than any kind of comfort, growth or development. Even if we have all the riches in the world but no freedom, we do not really have anything. Freedom is essential for all living beings be it man, a bird or trees. All beings strive for freedom and are happiest when free.

Any kind of compromise against freedom, then, is met with struggle. In the poem, 'The Trees', the poet Adrienne Rich presents the intensity of the efforts put in by the trees to break away from the bondage of man.

QUESTIONS

All parts of a tree, be it roots, leaves, small twigs and its long boughs stretch out to the maximum to break away from the enclosed walls of the house. They struggle hard to move out of the house, into the open-natural environment, to their natural habitat, i.e. forests.

Similar efforts are put by man and all other living species. One can look at the freedom struggle of countries all around the world. Not only do they do everything within their limits but people also give their lives for freedom. Therefore, one can say that freedom is gained after a lot of efforts.

QUESTIONS

11. What message does Adrienne Rich want to convey through the poem, 'The Trees'?

Ans. In her poem, "The Trees", the poet Adrienne Rich highlights the importance of trees and tries to give a message of afforestation. Without trees, the birds would not have a place to sit, insects will have no place to hide and the Sun would not be able to bury its feet (the Sunrays) in the shadows. When the trees are saplings, we enjoy the beauty of plants as they adorn the surroundings. But slowly the tree grows. It spreads its roots, its branches and leaves and seems to yearn to go outside where it can live and grow without any restrictions. The trees, then, lose all their beauty inside the house which they decorate.

The trees serve many purposes when planted in forests. They become a space wherein all other natural species of plants, animals, birds, insects etc. can survive. They are welcomed into nature by the strong winds and the moon.

QUESTIONS

The author hereby emphasizes that trees, need to be kept alive, but should not be 'imprisoned' inside the house as they look more beautiful outside. They tend to thrive outdoor where they actually belong.

QUESTIONS

12. The poem 'The Trees' appears to be about trees, environment, deforestation and afforestation. On a deeper level we discover that Adrienne Rich is expressing her concern about women and their emancipation. Elaborate with reference to the poem.

Ans. "The Trees" is a short symbolic poem focusing on the movement of trees that are initially indoors but seeking to escape to freedom in the forest. The trees represent nature but also the nature of being - womanhood in particular. 'The Trees', then, is an extended metaphor since the trees are indeed people, specifically females who are in need of healing.

Trees normally make up the forest but until now it's been empty for many days and nights. This is symbolic of women being left in the dark for too long not knowing their true identities and where they belong. Thus, there is a struggle for this identity and a new forest is formed. This new forest will take shape very quickly, overnight says the speaker, pointing towards a sort of change in identity, a collective identity for women.

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